05-20 第一篇

Microplastics: A Hidden Danger in Our Environment

When plastic bags and bottles break down in the environment, they do not disappear completely. They break into smaller and smaller pieces, some so tiny that we can hardly see them. These tiny pieces are called microplastics. [1] In fact, microplastics are plastic particles smaller than five millimetres—about the size of a sesame seed（芝麻）or smaller. They can come from large plastic waste that breaks apart, from microbeads in some face washes and toothpastes, or from synthetic（合成的）clothes when we wash them. That is why microplastics are now found almost everywhere: in the ocean, in soil, in the air we breathe, and even in our drinking water.

Where do microplastics go? [2] They are so small that they can enter the food chain easily. Small sea animals eat them, thinking they are food. Bigger fish eat those small animals, and the microplastics stay in their bodies. In the end, when we eat seafood, we may be eating microplastics too. In other words, microplastics move from the environment into animals and then into us. Scientists are still studying how much harm they cause to human health, but the presence of microplastics in our food and water is a growing concern.

Why are they hard to remove? [3] Because microplastics are so tiny, they pass through most filters and treatment systems. They spread through wind and water to places far from where they were first released. Once in the environment, they can stay for hundreds of years. Cleaning them from the ocean or soil is extremely difficult and expensive. For this reason, the best way to deal with microplastics is to reduce plastic use at the source—use less plastic, so fewer microplastics are created.

What can we do? [4] We can avoid products that contain microbeads and choose natural alternatives. Washing synthetic clothes less often or using a laundry bag that catches microfibres can help. Choosing products with less packaging and refusing single-use plastics also reduces the amount of plastic that may eventually become microplastics. So every small change in our daily habits can help slow down the growth of microplastic pollution.

[5] In short, microplastics are a serious environmental problem that affects both wildlife and ourselves. Although we cannot solve it overnight, we can take steps to reduce our plastic footprint. By being more conscious of what we buy and how we dispose of waste, we protect not only the planet but also our own health. Remember: the less plastic we use today, the fewer microplastics our children will face tomorrow.

选项

A. That is because microplastics are very small plastic pieces that come from many sources. B. In other words, microplastics travel from the environment into the food we eat. C. That is why preventing microplastics at the source is better than trying to clean them up. D. It is true that we can take daily actions to reduce microplastic pollution. E. In conclusion, we should reduce plastic use to protect the environment and our health. F. For example, some researchers use special nets to collect microplastics from the ocean.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：总领微塑料的定义与来源。空前描述"When plastic bags and bottles break down in the environment, they do not disappear completely. They break into smaller and smaller pieces, some so tiny that we can hardly see them. These tiny pieces are called microplastics"，空后说明"In fact, microplastics are plastic particles smaller than five millimetres—about the size of a sesame seed or smaller...They can come from large plastic waste that breaks apart, from microbeads in some face washes and toothpastes, or from synthetic clothes when we wash them...microplastics are now found almost everywhere: in the ocean, in soil, in the air we breathe, and even in our drinking water"。A选项"That is because microplastics are very small plastic pieces that come from many sources"（那是因为微塑料是来自多种来源的极小的塑料微粒）中"That is because"解释微塑料的性质，"very small...come from many sources"与空后smaller than 5mm、大块塑料、微珠、合成衣物精准对应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：微塑料进入食物链的路径。空前设问"Where do microplastics go?"，空后详述"They are so small that they can enter the food chain easily...Small sea animals eat them...Bigger fish eat those small animals, and the microplastics stay in their bodies...when we eat seafood, we may be eating microplastics too...microplastics move from the environment into animals and then into us...the presence of microplastics in our food and water is a growing concern"。B选项"In other words, microplastics travel from the environment into the food we eat"（换言之，微塑料从环境中进入我们吃的食物）中"In other words"概括空后内容，"travel from the environment into the food we eat"与空后food chain、seafood、into us完美呼应，衔接自然。
- **[3] C**：

- **线索**：源头减塑优于事后清理。空前设问"Why are they hard to remove?"，空后说明"Because microplastics are so tiny, they pass through most filters and treatment systems...They spread through wind and water to places far from where they were first released...Once in the environment, they can stay for hundreds of years...Cleaning them from the ocean or soil is extremely difficult and expensive...the best way to deal with microplastics is to reduce plastic use at the source—use less plastic, so fewer microplastics are created"。C选项"That is why preventing microplastics at the source is better than trying to clean them up"（因此从源头防止微塑料优于事后清理）中"That is why"承接空前及空后结论，"preventing at the source...better than trying to clean them up"与空后hard to remove、reduce at source精准对应，逻辑紧密。

- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：个人可采取的减塑行动。空前设问"What can we do?"，空后列举"We can avoid products that contain microbeads and choose natural alternatives...Washing synthetic clothes less often or using a laundry bag that catches microfibres can help...Choosing products with less packaging and refusing single-use plastics also reduces the amount of plastic...every small change in our daily habits can help slow down the growth of microplastic pollution"。D选项"It is true that we can take daily actions to reduce microplastic pollution"（的确，我们可以通过日常行动减少微塑料污染）中"It is true that"加强衔接，"daily actions to reduce"与空后avoid microbeads、wash less、less packaging、small change完美呼应，衔接得当。

- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：全文收束与减塑保护健康的呼吁。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"microplastics are a serious environmental problem that affects both wildlife and ourselves...we can take steps to reduce our plastic footprint...By being more conscious of what we buy and how we dispose of waste, we protect not only the planet but also our own health...the less plastic we use today, the fewer microplastics our children will face tomorrow"。E选项"In conclusion, we should reduce plastic use to protect the environment and our health"（总之，我们应减少塑料使用以保护环境和健康）用"In conclusion"总结全文，"reduce plastic use to protect the environment and our health"与空后plastic footprint、conscious、protect形成呼应，收束有力。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, some researchers use special nets to collect microplastics from the ocean.**：涉及用特制网采集海洋微塑料，易被误填[2]或[3]。但F讨论的是科研或清理手段，而空[2]聚焦微塑料进入食物链的路径，空[3]强调源头减塑优于清理；F属于清理方法举例，与空[2]的生态传递、空[3]的"源头减塑优先"论述方向相反。F属"主题相关但论述方向错位"型干扰。